

- Increase in memory texture. Textures were 2048 x 2048 or 4096 x 4096 in DirectX 9; in DX10 they're 8192 x 8192
- XInput. You can now use Xbox 360 peripherals with Windows Vista
- More life-like materials and characters with:
 - Animated fur & vegetation
 - Softer / sharper shadows
- Richer scenes; complex environments
 - Thicker forests, larger armies!
 - Dynamic and ever-changing in-game scenarios
- Realistic motion blurring
 - Volumetric effects
 - Thicker, more realistic smoke/clouds
- Other
 - Realistic reflections/refractions on water/cars/glass
- Reduced load on CPU
 - Re-routes bulk of graphics processing to GPU
 - Avoids glitching and system hangs during game play

11.2 The Games Explorer

One of the coolest features of Vista is the addition of the Games Explorer. This can be accessed from the Start menu directly by selecting Start > Games. You can also start it up by typing out “games” in the search panel in the Start Menu. The Games Explorer offers a one-



Many old games get registered with the Games Explorer as well

stop launch-pad to showcase and play your games. Any game installed under Windows Vista will find a home here. Games can